

A government intervention

It is no open secret that we – as honest, tax-paying, law-abiding citizens of this country – just absolutely love to hate our government with great amount of disdain, no matter whatever they do in our interest. Putting politicians and elected officials aside – the one that folks like you vote for – Indian bureaucracy isn't without its bright spots. Here we highlight one such star who, with the help of technology, is trying to make systems more efficient and the wheels of government machinery work flawlessly, with greater accountability within all stakeholders.

The single-minded aim is to bring in simplicity, efficiency and transparency with the help of technology. Efficient service delivery is at the top of Mr. Aggarwal's mandate to give the government a much-needed facelift. He's quick to highlight innovative steps taken by the government in the last couple of years in this regard. "More than 35,000 Common Service Centers (CSC) have been set up across Maharashtra, primarily in rural areas, to facilitate delivery of services near the doorstep of citizens. Focus has also been on e-Services, thus reducing the public's need to travel to Government offices. Websites, applications, forms have been designed in Marathi to enable greater reach," says Mr. Aggarwal. He also mentions that applications are now being made WCAG compliant (<http://www.w3.org/WAI/intro/wcag>) to enable differently abled citizens to access them,

“UID linkage with various scheme data has shown potential duplicates. Similarly, we have analyzed data of multiple departments and have seen issues in data quality including inconsistency in name, age, address etc. for which corrective action is being taken by the respective line departments. Our UID Innovation Center has played a significant role in data analysis. There is a need to link databases which in turn would ensure services reach the right person.”



RAJESH AGGARWAL

Rajesh Aggarwal is currently serving as the Secretary IT, Govt. of Maharashtra. A B.Tech. in Computer Science from IIT Delhi (1983-87), Mr Aggarwal has been a technology enthusiast focusing on a wide array of aspects including Natural Language Understanding, Algorithms, Artificial Intelligence, Fuzzy matching and de-duplication of databases, GIS, Analytics and has the experience of working with very large citizen databases. He is also a prolific writer and has written numerous articles and papers on e-Governance, including the much acclaimed paper titled 'e-Gov 0.0 – the fundamentals of e-Governance'.

thus fostering inclusive growth.

While working in the Election Commission of India, Mr Aggarwal found it exciting to work on the merging of two very different databases of Voter Cards and Voter Lists. Now the photo rolls, which have photos of voters printed in

the voter lists, are being used across the country, substantially reducing the false voter fraud.

With regards to efficient citizen analysis, a UID Innovation Center has been setup in Mumbai to focus on deduplication, seeding, analysis and research based on UID, according to Mr Aggarwal. Due to this, UID data is increasingly used for linking with various beneficiary data to identify and remove potential bogus and duplicates, thus ensuring that benefits reach the intended beneficiaries. State Data Center has been established in Mumbai, including a fully functional Government Cloud. "This is the first instance of any State Government implementing a Government cloud," claims Mr Aggarwal. "This has significantly reduced the time taken to deploy applications and resulted in reduction in cost of deployment. We have introduced e-Tendering for all tenders above ₹10